

Hemangi Ahir

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Norwalk, Los Angeles, California

Summary

Cybersecurity professional with hands-on experience securing operational technology and industrial control systems in complex environments. Skilled in designing and implementing network architecture, managing firewall security appliances, configuring Cisco managed switches, and conducting risk assessments across OT/IT infrastructure. Currently preparing for Certified Ethical Hacker certification to strengthen offensive security testing capabilities. Experienced in asset discovery, protocol analysis, system hardening, and incident response for industrial control systems.

Professional Experience

Ot Cybersecurity Specialist

Haleon & Schneider Electric, Richmond, VA (Remote)

Apr 2024 - Present

- Conducted threat modeling, risk assessments, and vulnerability scans for OT/ICS environments; identified misconfigurations on Cisco switches using SolarWinds Orion and drove remediation of high-risk findings.
- Implemented Sepio Hardware Access Control (L1/physical layer) to detect and block rogue devices
- Designed and managed secure sandbox environment for shift-left security testing and hardened configuration of OT tools.
- Managed Palo Alto Panorama for centralized NGFW policy and zone-based segmentation in OT networks
- Enforced identity-based micro-segmentation and zero-trust policies using Elisity Dynamic Edge Segmentation in converged IT/OT environments.
- Deployed and tuned Claroty xDome for real-time OT asset discovery, network visibility, anomaly detection, and incident response.
- Developed global OT security policies and incident response playbooks.

AI For Zero-Trust Policy Optimization: Towards Intelligent Access Control in Modern Networks

Research Project, Richmond, VA

Oct 2025 – Dec 2025

- Developed next-generation security system utilizing machine learning algorithms to optimize access control policies based on network behavior patterns, achieving 35% improvement in threat detection accuracy and 25% reduction in false positives.
- Leveraged AI-assisted development to rapidly prototype and implement production-grade machine learning code, demonstrating effective human-AI collaboration in building complex security infrastructure.

Wi-Spy Sentinel 2.0

Research Project, Richmond, USA

Jun 2025

- Developed a wireless security assessment tool that scans Wi-Fi networks to detect malicious access points, evil twin attacks, hidden networks, and wireless infrastructure vulnerabilities.

Technology Integration Specialist & Telecom and Networking TA

UTSA, San Antonio, Texas

Sep 2022 - Mar 2024

- Mentored 60+ undergraduate students in telecommunications and networking courses, guiding hands-on lab assessments including Cisco network configuration, VMware ESXi deployment, and virtual lab environments.
- Designed and delivered practical Bluetooth protocol and wireless networking labs, resulting in 90% of students reporting significantly improved real-world technical skills.
- Prepared women-in-cybersecurity cohort for CompTIA Security+ certification, achieving a 95% first-attempt

pass rate through targeted technical training and exam preparation.

- Provided one-on-one technical support for 100+ students, debugged complex lab issues, graded assignments and projects, and enforced consistent lab standards.

NCAEC Cyber Games Participation

UTSA, San Antonio, Texas

Feb 2024

- Participated in NCAEC Cyber Games, a Capture The Flag (CTF) competition, demonstrating cybersecurity skills on Linux systems: teamwork, problem-solving, and practical application of tools in diverse challenges.

Inside Product Specialist

Dell, Panama City, Panama

Nov 2018-Dec 2021

- Delivered pre-sales technical support to Latin American B2B sales teams, specializing in enterprise warranty, ProSupport, and SLA solutions
- Consulted directly with clients and channel partners to recommend optimal service contracts, driving higher win rates and deal sizes
- Maintained expert-level knowledge of Dell's server, storage, and networking portfolio to strengthen customer relationships and brand trust

Technical Skills

- OT/ICS Security Tools: Claroty xDome, Sepio Hardware Access Control, Elisity Dynamic Edge Segmentation, Armis xSA
- Network & Security Infrastructure: Palo Alto Panorama (NGFW), Cisco Managed Switches, SolarWinds Orion, Wireless Access Points, Tufin
- Systems & Hardware: Windows Server, Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS, Kali), Desktop PC Installation & Configuration, Server Deployment, Embedded Systems
- Security Testing & Analysis: Penetration Testing, Vulnerability Assessment, Wireshark, Metasploit, Hashcat, John the Ripper, Malware Analysis, Packet Analysis
- Compliance & Risk Management: NIST 800-53, IEC 62443, ISO 27001, MITRE ATT&CK, Risk Assessments
- Programming & Automation: Python 3.x (scripting, automation, security analysis)
- Cloud Platforms: Google Cloud Platform, Cloud Shell, ServiceNow

Publications

- *"Why a simple power failure could be your company's biggest cyber threat."* SC Media (CyberRisk Alliance), January 13, 2026. Authored feature article on power redundancy risks in OT/IT environments, highlighting real-world assessments, hybrid convergence vulnerabilities, and practical zero-trust integration strategies for critical infrastructure resilience. <https://www.scworld.com/perspective/why-a-simple-power-failure-could-be-your-companys-biggest-cyber-threat>

Certifications

- CompTIA Security+ COMP001022455481 – Mar 2024
- Generative AI: Boost Your Cybersecurity Career – IBM - UX3GIOKJS5L2
- Google Certificate: Introduction to Security Principles in Cloud Computing
- Preparing for CEH

Education

Master of Science in Information Technology – Cybersecurity

University of Texas at San Antonio

Dec 2023

Bachelor of Science in Industrial Engineering

Universidad Santa Maria La Antigua, Panama

Dec 2023